

The 17 Tips

An invitation to reflect, to question yourselves and to look at life from a different perspective.

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Before we say goodbye

Throughout life, we keep coming across ideas, principles and different ways of understanding the world. We learn some of them from our parents, others from our teachers, from books, from the people we admire, from our conversations and, very often, from our own experiences. Some remain simply as lessons learned; others end up becoming principles that guide our decisions, our relationships and, ultimately, our way of living.

And it is precisely in our own lives that those ideas take on real meaning. Before we are businesspeople, leaders, professionals or entrepreneurs, we are people. And it is in our own microcosm —in our decisions, relationships, habits and way of seeing the world— that the flame is lit that makes it possible **to live and exercise the conscious leadership the world so badly needs.**

That is why I wanted to leave you these tips. They are not meant to be rules or absolute truths. They are simply a few things I have learned, thought about and come to value over the course of my own life, and that I wish someone had shared with me when I was your age.

Take them for what they are: **an invitation to reflect, to question yourselves and, perhaps, to look at some things in life from a different perspective.**

1 Don’t betray who you are in order to fit in

Never do something solely out of social pressure, to fit in, to belong or out of fear of *“what people will say”*.

The world is full of people capable of accepting you and valuing you for who you really are. Don’t waste your time or your energy trying to please people who, in order to accept you, demand that you stop being yourselves.

Belonging should never cost you your authenticity. Surround yourselves with people with whom you can be yourselves, without having to betray your values, your personality or what you believe in.

2 Learn to value your privacy

You were born in an era in which it seems that, by default, everything must be public. And that is not necessarily wrong: social media are extraordinary tools. They amplify what you do, generate a kind of exposure that was once unimaginable and open up unprecedented possibilities for business and monetization.

Use them to your advantage. **Use them as tools to make yourselves known, drive your projects forward, build a brand and create opportunities.** But don't confuse exposure with an obligation to share everything.

Even if life leads you to become content creators or influencers, learn to keep a part of your life that belongs to no one else.

Keep moments that are yours alone. Relationships that don't need an audience. Experiences that don't have to become a story, a post or a video.

Not everything valuable needs to be published. Some things become even more valuable when only you know they happened.

3 Learn to see the glass half full

Never lose sight of all the good that already exists in your lives. Make the ability to recognize what you have —even in difficult moments— a guiding principle of your life.

This does not mean settling or giving up on ambition. **You can want more and, at the same time, deeply value what you already have.** In fact, I believe that combination is far more powerful than living permanently with the feeling that something is missing.

Gratitude changes the way we see the world. It allows us to recognize opportunities, to value the people around us and to enjoy the achievements that we would otherwise take for granted.

Gratitude is also a door that leads to more and better opportunities: those who learn to recognize the value of what they have are usually much better prepared to make the most of what comes next.

On the contrary, those who have a great deal and never value it, those who live looking only at what they lack, may end up sowing —without realizing it— the seed of their own misfortune.

> Don't wait to lose something to discover how much it was worth.

4 There is no better time to start something than now

There is no better age to start something than the one you are today. The years ahead will also bring opportunities, but **none will have exactly the conditions, the energy, the time and the freedom you have at this stage of your life.**

Don't wait until you feel completely prepared. Don't wait until you have more money, more experience or the perfect moment. **Start.** Make mistakes, learn, try again and build as you go.

Make the most of all the resources, knowledge, contacts, spaces and opportunities that the Tec makes available to you. You are surrounded by people, tools and possibilities that you may never again have so close at hand and so easily within reach.

And remember this: **the sacrifices you make today can become opportunities worth many times more tomorrow.**

The time, experience and relationships you build while you are young are an investment whose true return you may not see right away, but which can multiply many times over throughout your lives.

> Don't put off until tomorrow what you can start building today.

5 Learn out of curiosity, not obligation

Learn to learn out of curiosity, and not only out of obligation.

Curiosity is one of the most powerful keys to real learning: not the kind that is memorized for an exam and then forgotten, but the kind that **is understood, absorbed and ends up becoming a tool you can use.**

When something truly interests you, you don't need anyone to force you to dig deeper. You ask, you research, you connect ideas, you experiment and you look for answers on your own initiative. And that knowledge is far more likely to stay with you and to become judgment, skills and experience.

Cultivate curiosity, then. Constantly ask yourselves *"Why?"*, *"How does it work?"*, *"What would happen if...?"* and *"What else can I learn from this?"*

> University can teach you many things; curiosity can teach you for your entire life.

6 Learn to learn from other people's experience

Learn to learn from others. While it is important —and always will be— to gain your own experience, there is also an enormous amount of knowledge we can obtain by observing the path others have already traveled.

There are things that can only be learned by living them, by making mistakes and by personally facing the consequences of our decisions. But not everything has to be that way. One of the abilities that can most accelerate your learning is observing the mistakes and successes of others, studying their experiences and learning from them without necessarily having to repeat the same path.

This is how humanity has built its knowledge. Each generation starts, to a great extent, on the foundations left by those before it. Those who discovered quantum physics did not have to rediscover classical physics. Those who developed the diesel engine did not have to reinvent the steam engine. Innovation advances because someone was able to learn what another had already discovered and use it as a starting point to go further.

The same is true of life. Read the stories of the people you admire. Listen to their testimonies. Observe their decisions. Study their mistakes, their successes, their failures and what they did differently. There is an enormous amount of wisdom available in other people's experiences, if we have the humility and the curiosity to seek it out.

Of course you will have to make your own mistakes. It is inevitable. But try to make sure they are mistakes over stones no one has tripped on before; that they are experiences that allow you to discover something new, leave a new testimony and build on what others have already learned.

Don't waste your life relearning, at an unnecessary cost, what someone else has already had the generosity to teach.

Learn from those who came before. Learn from those who are beside you. Learn from those who have already traveled the path you want to follow.

Learn from other people's experience so that you can go further with your own.

7 Transform the way you relate to the world

Transform the way you relate to the world.

Don't go through life as mere spectators of what happens around you. Learn to look beyond yourselves and to constantly ask what you can contribute, what you can improve and what you can leave better than you found it.

Seek to create value for those around you: your colleagues, collaborators, employees, neighbors, friends, children, older adults and, especially, for those who are in more vulnerable situations.

But don't limit that responsibility to people. We are part of something much bigger than ourselves. Also seek to create value and to reduce the impact you have on your surroundings: care for animals, green spaces, nature reserves and the ecosystems on which we all depend.

You don't need to wait until you have a large company, a great fortune or a position of power to start doing so. Transforming the world also begins with small everyday decisions: in how you treat people, how you do business, what you consume, what you protect, what you teach, what you share and what you are willing to leave better than you found it.

In the end, the question should not be only:

"How much can I earn?"

but also:

"How much value can I create for others with what I have, with what I know and with what I do?"

There is a vast difference between someone who settles for being just another passenger, an indifferent spectator of what happens around them, and someone who recognizes in themselves a guardian, a steward, a true agent of change.

Don't underestimate the impact a single person can have when they decide to live this way.

One decision can change a relationship. One relationship can change a life. One life can change a community. And one community can change the world.

Transform, then, the way you relate to the world. Learn to see it not only as something that was given to you, but also as something you have the responsibility and the opportunity to influence.

Because perhaps one of the most important questions you can ask yourselves throughout your life is not only **what you want to get from the world, but what you want to leave to the world when you are gone.**

8 Awaken the mentor you carry inside

Awaken the mentor you carry inside. A great leader is, above all, someone who helps others grow.

When you have people under your charge, don't limit yourselves to telling them what to do, supervising their work or measuring their results. **Teach them, listen to them, share what you know, help them discover their strengths and give them the tools so that one day they can surpass you.**

A true leader does not build dependence; they build capable, confident and autonomous people.

And this calling as a mentor is not limited to the professional sphere. If life grants you the opportunity and the responsibility of being parents, you will discover that one of your great missions will be precisely that: **to accompany, teach, guide and prepare your children so they can build their own path.**

Always look for opportunities to leave people a little better than you found them.

> The true legacy of a leader lies not only in what they built, but in the people they helped build.

9 Learn the art of giving before asking

Learn the art of giving and of giving yourselves without expecting anything in return.

Every time you help, teach, share, recommend, connect two people or put your talent at the service of someone else, you are sowing something. **And many of those seeds will bear fruit in due time**, perhaps in ways and in places you cannot imagine today.

The return will not always be evident. Sometimes it will not even come from the person you helped. It may take the form of an opportunity, a recommendation, a friendship, an alliance or, simply, a door that opens and leads to many other doors.

So, reach out your hand. Help when you can. Share what you know. Give value before asking what you can get in return.

And remember something very important in your professional lives: **you will not always have to ask for an opportunity; many times you will be able to build it by first demonstrating what you are capable of doing.**

Give a trial of your value. Offer a sample of what you can do. Solve a problem. Contribute before you are paid to do so. **Let your actions speak for you, and let the value you create be what determines how much you are worth.**

And one day, when you are the ones who need a hand, you may discover that someone is there to extend theirs to you.

> Give first. Create value. Prove your worth. Doors tend to open for those who have already shown that they know how to build.

10 Learn the art of empathy

Learn the art of putting yourselves in other people's shoes.

Empathy is much more than understanding what another person feels. It is making a genuine effort to **see the world from their perspective**, to understand their circumstances, their needs, their motivations and whatever it is that we ourselves may not be seeing.

If you manage to develop this ability in an authentic and honest way, it will become one of the most valuable tools of your lives. It will help you lead better, negotiate better, sell better, work better as a team and build much deeper and more lasting relationships.

But, above all, it will help you be better people.

Cultivate it with your colleagues, your collaborators, your clients, your friends, your partners and with everyone who is part of your life. Before judging, try to understand. Before responding, listen. Before assuming, ask.

> *Empathy is not a skill you learn for one stage of life or for one profession. It is a tool that never expires.*

And the sooner you learn to use it, the further it will take you.

11 Never confuse your identity with what you own

Never confuse who you are with what you have —or with what you do not yet have.

Money, possessions and wealth are tools. They are means that can give you freedom, allow you to start businesses, invest, travel, live more comfortably and build a better quality of life. **But they must never become the ultimate goal of your lives.**

Don't let your personal worth depend on the size of your bank account, the car you drive, the house you live in or the symbols of success you may accumulate.

Because what matters is not only **what you have, but what you do with what you have.**

How you use your money. Whom you help. What you build. What opportunities you create for others. What you choose to protect. What you are willing to share. And, above all, what kind of person you choose to be when you have more possibilities and more resources.

> *Your possessions may say how much you have; your decisions say who you are.*

Build wealth, yes. Seek prosperity, yes. Enjoy what you achieve. But never forget that possessions are tools for building the life you want, not the measure of your worth as people.

12 Learn to value the process

Learn to value processes, and not only results. And, even more importantly, learn to value **who the process turns you into**.

The degree you are beginning is much more than a path toward a diploma. It is one of the first highly significant processes you will face in your lives: there will be moments of enthusiasm, of frustration, of uncertainty, of effort and of doubt. But each one of them will have something to teach you.

Because in the end, the true value of a process lies not only in reaching the goal, but in **the abilities, the character and the mindset you developed along the way.**

Life's great projects work the same way. Starting a company, building a career, forming a family, building wealth or achieving any important goal takes time and demands discipline, consistency, perseverance, resilience, determination and a genuine long-term mindset.

It also requires learning to think strategically: knowing when to move forward, when to change course, when to persist and when to recognize that a strategy no longer works.

Don't become obsessed only with getting there. **Pay attention to who you are becoming as you move forward.**

Because when you finally reach the goal, you may discover that the real prize was not what you achieved, but **the person you had to become in order to achieve it.**

13 Learn to be careful with your choices

Learn to understand the power of your choices. We have already talked about how you are not what you have —nor what you do not have— and about how the true value of a process lies, to a great extent, in the person it turns you into. But there is something even more important to understand: processes do not transform us by themselves. They transform us according to what we do and what we fail to do as we go through them.

And what we do and fail to do is determined, to a large extent, by our choices.

Not only by the big decisions we make from time to time, but by those small, granular, almost atomic choices that we repeat every day and that, piled one on top of another over time, end up building our lives.

What you read. What captures your attention. What you decide to prioritize. Whom you choose to spend your time with. What you research. What knowledge you seek. What you aspire to. What habits you cultivate. What vices you indulge. How you eat. What you decide to study and what you decide to ignore. What improvements you pursue. What flaws you are willing to correct, and which ones you allow to remain until they become a kind of gangrene of your character.

All of those decisions seem small when looked at in isolation. But none of them really is.

Every choice is a small input that feeds the process of becoming someone. And that process repeats itself tomorrow, and the day after tomorrow, and the day after that. Over time, the accumulation of those decisions ends up showing itself in your habits; your habits end up shaping your actions; your actions end up building your results; and, even more importantly, they end up building the person you have become.

That is why you should be very careful with what you seem to consider insignificant.

Don't accidentally become someone you never decided to be.

Ask yourselves often: What am I doing every day? What am I failing to do? What am I allowing to occupy my attention? Whom am I spending my time with? What habits am I building? What flaws am I tolerating? And toward what kind of person are all these decisions leading me?

Because in the end, our lives do not usually change because of a single big decision. They change through the accumulation of thousands of small decisions.

Choose carefully.

Every day you are voting, with your actions and your omissions, for the person you will become tomorrow.

14 Learn the art of frugality

Learn the art of frugality: **learn to live below your means.**

It is not about living poorly, depriving yourselves of everything you enjoy or turning money into a source of restrictions. It is about learning to distinguish between **what you need, what you truly value and what you simply can afford to buy.**

Living below your means will spare you a great deal of pressure and many headaches. But, more importantly, it will give you something much more valuable: **freedom.**

When your expenses are below your income, a capacity appears that can completely change your future: saving.

And saving opens another door: **investment.**

Investment, in turn, can turn part of what you earn today into assets that work for you tomorrow. That is how a virtuous circle begins: earning, spending less than you earn, saving, investing and doing it again for many years.

You don't need to earn a fortune to start building wealth. You need to learn **not to spend everything you earn.**

> Frugality is not about having less; it is about needing less so you can do more with what you have.

15 Dare to do what you love

Dare to do what you love. If you have a great passion, explore the possibility of turning it into your profession, your trade and, why not, what puts food on your table.

But learn to recognize that this is a privilege. **It is not always possible, and it is certainly not always easy.** Finding a way to make a living doing what you are passionate about can take years, requires sacrifices and, at times, means first building the conditions that make it possible.

That is why, until that moment comes —or if it never comes—, learn also to love your trade.

Don't wait for the perfect job to appear before giving your best. If you have already decided to do it, **do it with passion, with pride and with excellence.** Give yourselves to it the way someone who truly loves what they do would.

Because there is something powerful in this: sometimes we don't find our passion first and then do our work; **sometimes we do our work so well, with so much dedication and mastery, that we end up finding passion in it.**

You will not always be able to choose what you do. But you will almost always be able to choose **how you do it and who you decide to be while you do it.**

> Pursue what you love when you can. And when you can't, learn to love and give yourselves to whatever your trade may be.

16 Learn to master self-management

Life —and particularly professional life— will become more complex as you move forward. There will be more responsibilities, more projects, more commitments, more people depending on you and, probably, more things competing for your time and attention.

And there will come a time when you will feel that it is increasingly difficult to devote time to that hobby you used to enjoy so much, to get together with your old friends or even simply to sit down and spend time with your family and create those memorable moments that truly recharge your batteries.

> *The chaos is real. But don't let chaos become your way of life.*

As you move forward in your lives, you will have to develop the ability to impose order on that chaos: learning to set priorities, protect your time, keep perspective, focus on what truly matters and, above all, learn to say no.

Set boundaries. Reserve time for yourselves. Take care of your relationships. Protect what gives you energy and meaning. Don't let professional success end up charging you, as its price, the very things that made success worthwhile.

Because managing a company, a team, a project or a career is important. **But before learning to manage anything, you have to learn to manage yourselves.**

True success does not consist of having a perfectly ordered life —that will probably never exist—, but of developing the ability to regain order, focus and perspective every time life inevitably makes you lose them.

> The pillar of truly sustainable success is self-management: mastering yourselves before attempting to master anything else.

17 Make God the axis of your life

Make God the axis, the origin and the center of your lives.

God is love. God loves you. And God wants you to love Him back: willingly, out of conviction and not out of obligation. Love Him back.

Love also the life that has been given to you. Love those around you. Love all of God's creation. Learn to contemplate it, to respect it, to be grateful for it and to marvel at it.

We are far too used to living absorbed in ourselves, as if we were the origin and the center of the universe; as if everything revolved around us, our desires, our worries, our plans and our ambitions.

And, in the midst of all that, we forget something fundamental: **life is fleeting. It slips away from us in a second.**

We come into this world with nothing and we will leave it with nothing. And between the one and the other, in what seems barely the blink of an eye, we are granted the extraordinary opportunity to live.

That is why you should **embrace life for what it is: a gift from God.**

And learn also to surrender yourselves to His Providence. Trust in it, even when you don't understand the path; even when things don't turn out as you had planned; even when what you asked for does not come.

Because God's Providence, in its infinite mystery, will not always give you what you want.

> *It will give you what you truly need.*

You may not understand it at the time. You may even rebel against it. But learn to trust, to be grateful and to keep walking.

Do your part. **Do your best and let God do the rest.** Work, dream, build, strive and pursue what you consider good and valuable. But remember that you are not the center of everything and that you don't have to carry the burden of controlling everything.

> *Put God at the center. Love truly. Live fully. And trust in His Providence.*

In the end, perhaps the most important question of your lives is not what you achieved, how much you accumulated or what you became, but **what you did with the gift of life that God gave you.**

“Happiness is only real
when shared.”

— Christopher McCandless, aka Alexander Supertramp

